

☐ CHOKING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Stay calm and gently restrain the dog - a panicked dog may bite.
- 2 Open the mouth and look for a visible object.
- 3 If you can see it clearly, sweep it out with a finger - never push it deeper.
- 4 Small dog: hold upside down and give firm back blows between the shoulder blades.
- 5 Large dog: lift the hind legs (wheelbarrow) and give back blows.
- 6 Still choking: firm abdominal thrusts just behind the ribcage.
- 7 Get to a vet immediately, even once the object is out.

General guidance, not a substitute for a vet. In an emergency, contact your vet or an emergency animal hospital immediately.

☐ POISONING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Do NOT induce vomiting unless a vet specifically tells you to.
- 2 Identify the substance: name, estimated amount, time of ingestion.
- 3 Key toxins: grapes/raisins, xylitol, chocolate, macadamias, rat bait, paracetamol, lilies.
- 4 Call your vet or emergency animal hospital immediately - bring the packaging.
- 5 Watch for vomiting, tremors, drooling, lethargy, seizures.
- 6 Never give milk, salt water or home remedies without vet instruction.
- 7 Keep the dog warm and calm - get to an emergency vet without delay.

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☐ OVERHEATING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Move the dog to shade or air-conditioning immediately.
- 2 Offer small amounts of cool - not ice-cold - water.
- 3 Wet the coat with cool water, especially belly, paws and armpits.
- 4 Use a fan to speed up cooling.
- 5 Do NOT use ice or ice water - it can cause shock.
- 6 Watch for heavy panting, drooling, bright red gums, collapse.
- 7 Get to a vet - heatstroke can be fatal even after cooling.

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□ SNAKE BITE

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Keep the dog as still and calm as possible - movement spreads venom.
- 2 Carry the dog if you can; keep the bite below heart level.
- 3 Do NOT wash the wound, apply a tourniquet, or try to suck out venom.
- 4 Note the snake's appearance if safe - never chase it.
- 5 Watch for weakness, drooling, dilated pupils, collapse.
- 6 Get to a vet or emergency hospital now - antivenom is time-critical.

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□ SPIDER BITE

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Keep the dog calm and still.
- 2 Identify the spider if safe - redback and funnel-web are dangerous.
- 3 Apply a cold compress to reduce swelling.
- 4 Do NOT bandage tightly or apply a tourniquet.
- 5 Watch for muscle tremors, vomiting, weakness, difficulty breathing.
- 6 Get to a vet immediately for funnel-web or redback bites.

General guidance, not a substitute for a vet. In an emergency, contact your vet or an emergency animal hospital immediately.

□ DROWNING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Get the dog out of the water safely - mind your own safety first.
- 2 Small dog: hold upside down briefly to drain water. Large dog: lie on its side, head lower.
- 3 Check for breathing and a heartbeat.
- 4 Not breathing: close the mouth and give rescue breaths into the nose.
- 5 No heartbeat: begin CPR chest compressions.
- 6 Keep the dog warm and get to a vet - secondary drowning can occur hours later.

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□ TICKS

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Check the whole body - head, ears, neck, and between the toes.
- 2 Use fine tweezers or a tick remover, gripping close to the skin.
- 3 Pull straight out with steady pressure - don't twist or squeeze the body.
- 4 Do NOT burn it or use chemicals.
- 5 Save the tick in a container for identification.
- 6 Watch for wobbliness, weakness, vomiting or breathing changes (paralysis tick).
- 7 See a vet urgently if any paralysis-tick signs appear.

General guidance, not a substitute for a vet. In an emergency, contact your vet or an emergency animal hospital immediately.

SEIZURES

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Stay calm and note the time - most seizures last under 2 minutes.
- 2 Clear the area of hard or sharp objects.
- 3 Do NOT put your hands near the mouth - you may be bitten.
- 4 Dim the lights and keep noise down.
- 5 Do not restrain the dog; let the seizure run its course.
- 6 A seizure over 5 minutes, or repeated seizures, is an emergency.
- 7 Keep the dog cool afterwards and call your vet.

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□ DOG FIGHT

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Do NOT grab collars or reach between the dogs - you will be bitten.
- 2 Make a loud noise, use a hose, or throw water to break focus.
- 3 Use a barrier - a board, bag or chair - to separate them.
- 4 Locked grip: use the wheelbarrow method - each person lifts a dog's hind legs and pulls back.
- 5 Once apart, keep the dogs separated and leashed.
- 6 Check both dogs for puncture wounds - they hide under fur.
- 7 See a vet - bite wounds often become infected.

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□ BLEEDING

IMMEDIATE ACTION STEPS

- 1 Apply firm, direct pressure with a clean cloth or gauze.
- 2 Hold pressure for at least 3-5 minutes without lifting to check.
- 3 If blood soaks through, add more cloth on top - don't remove the first.
- 4 Raise the wound above heart level if possible.
- 5 For a limb, a snug (not tourniquet-tight) bandage can help.
- 6 Watch for pale gums, weakness, rapid breathing - signs of shock.
- 7 Get to a vet for anything deep, spurting, or that won't stop.

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